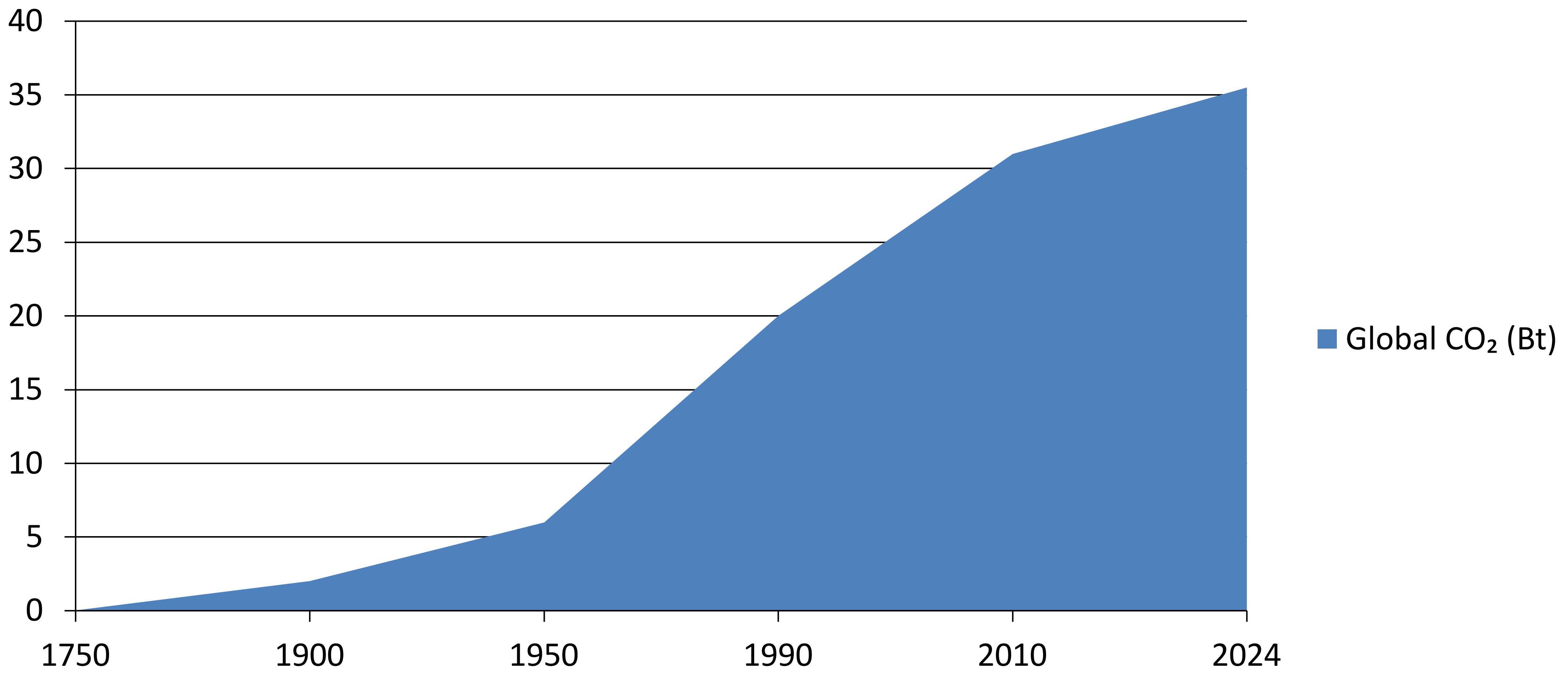
Global CO_2 Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

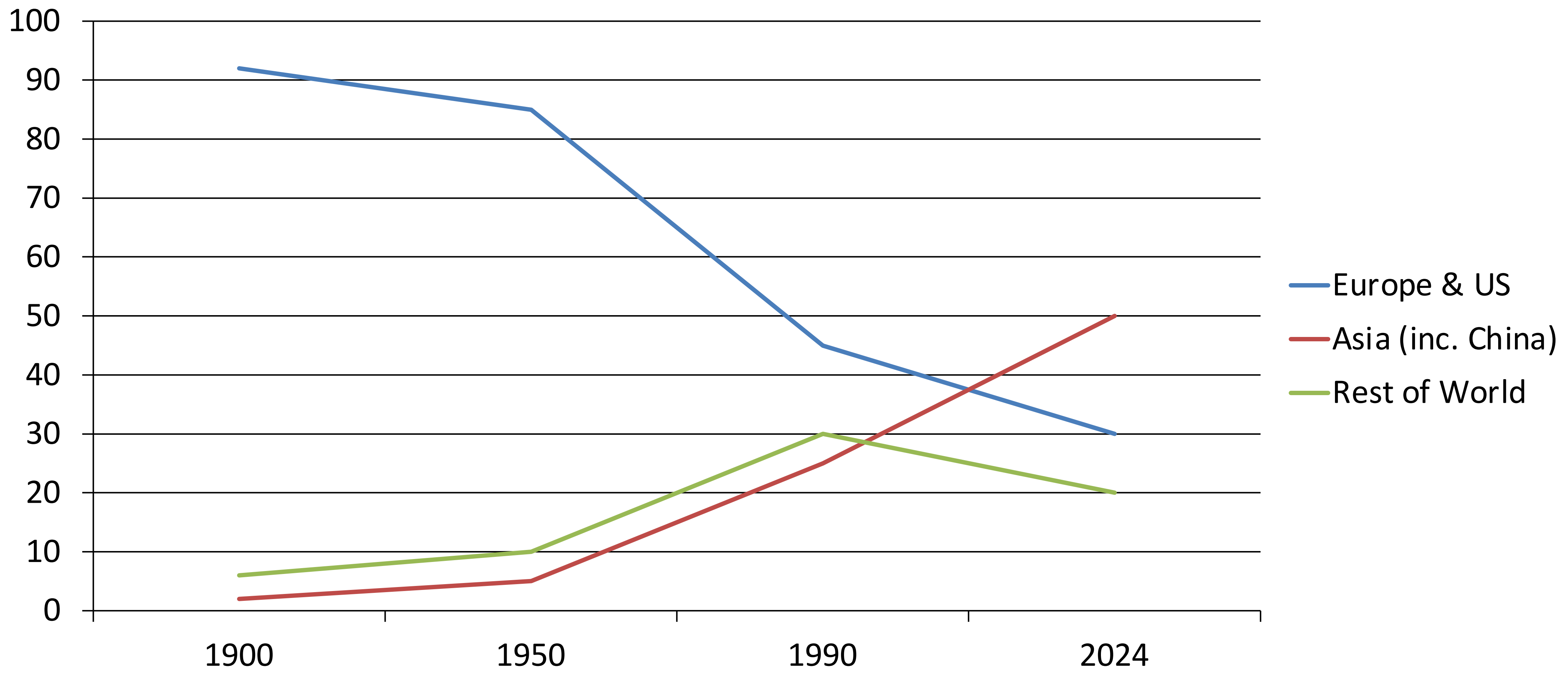
Fossil fuels & industry, 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

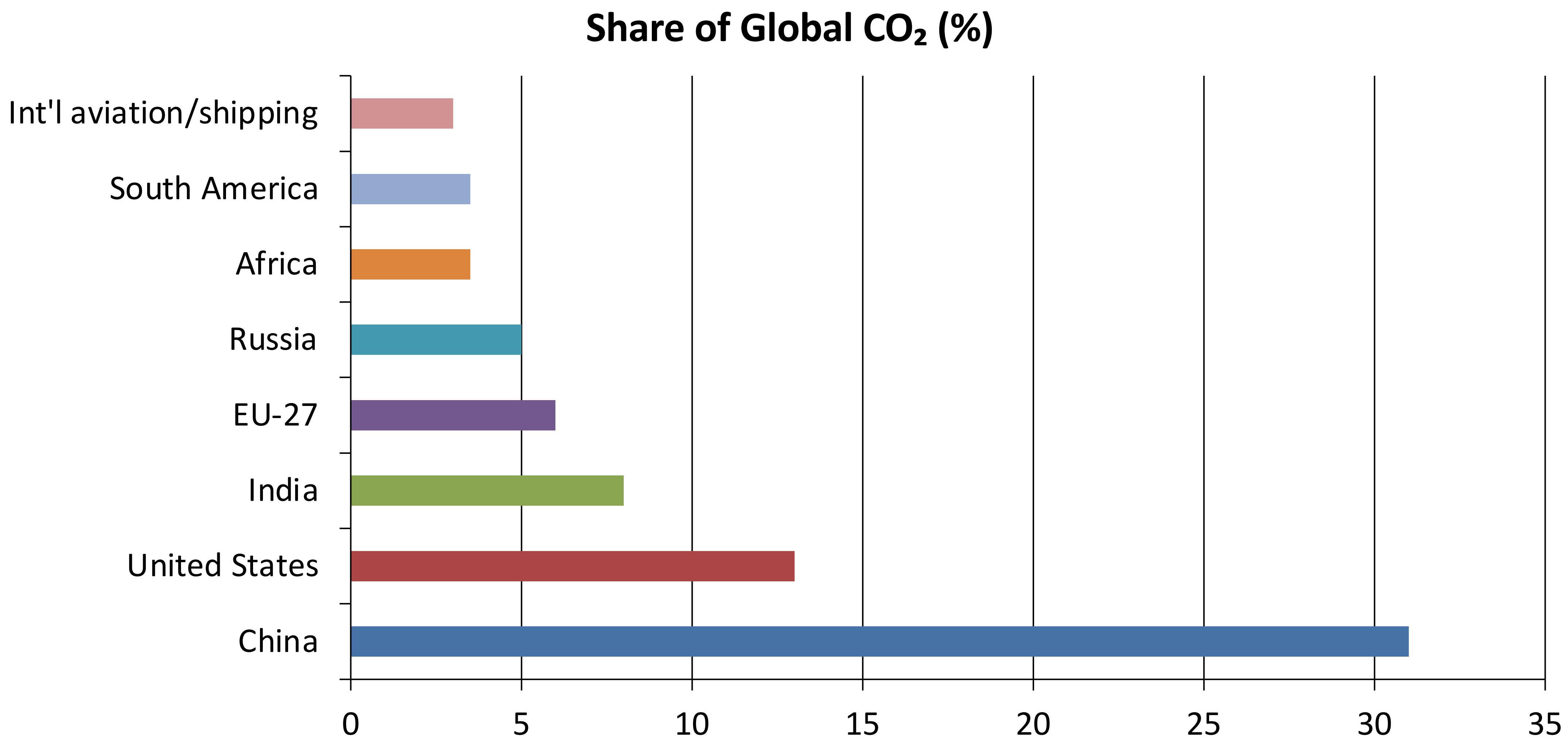
Global CO_2 Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



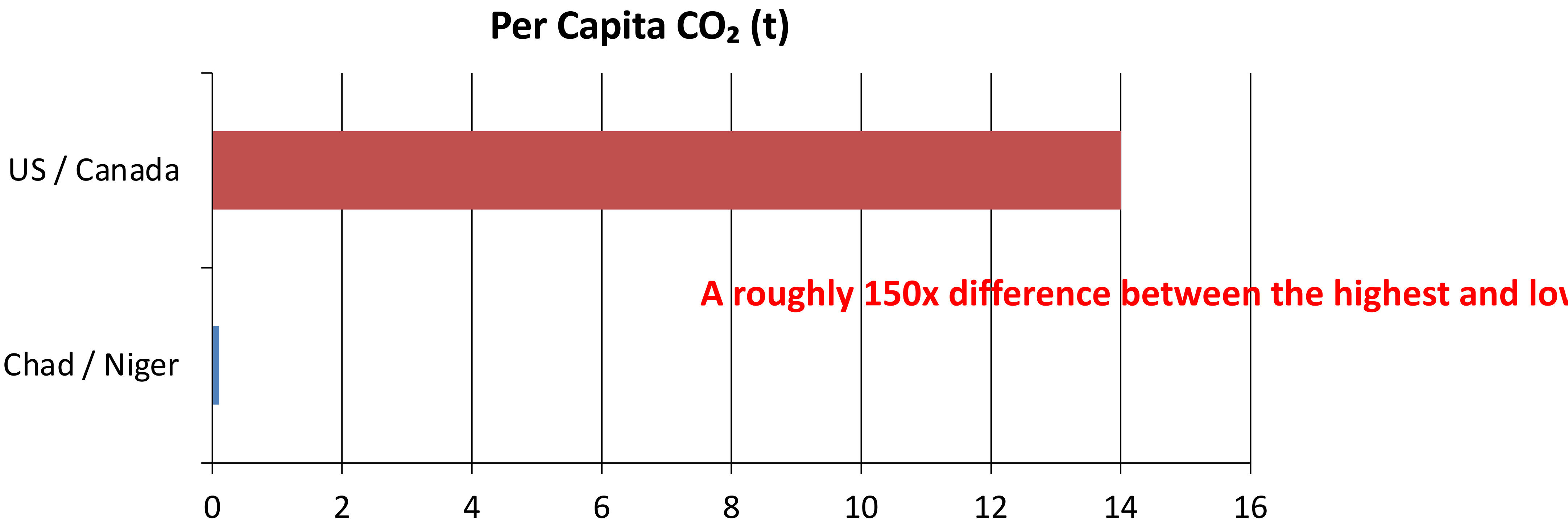
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



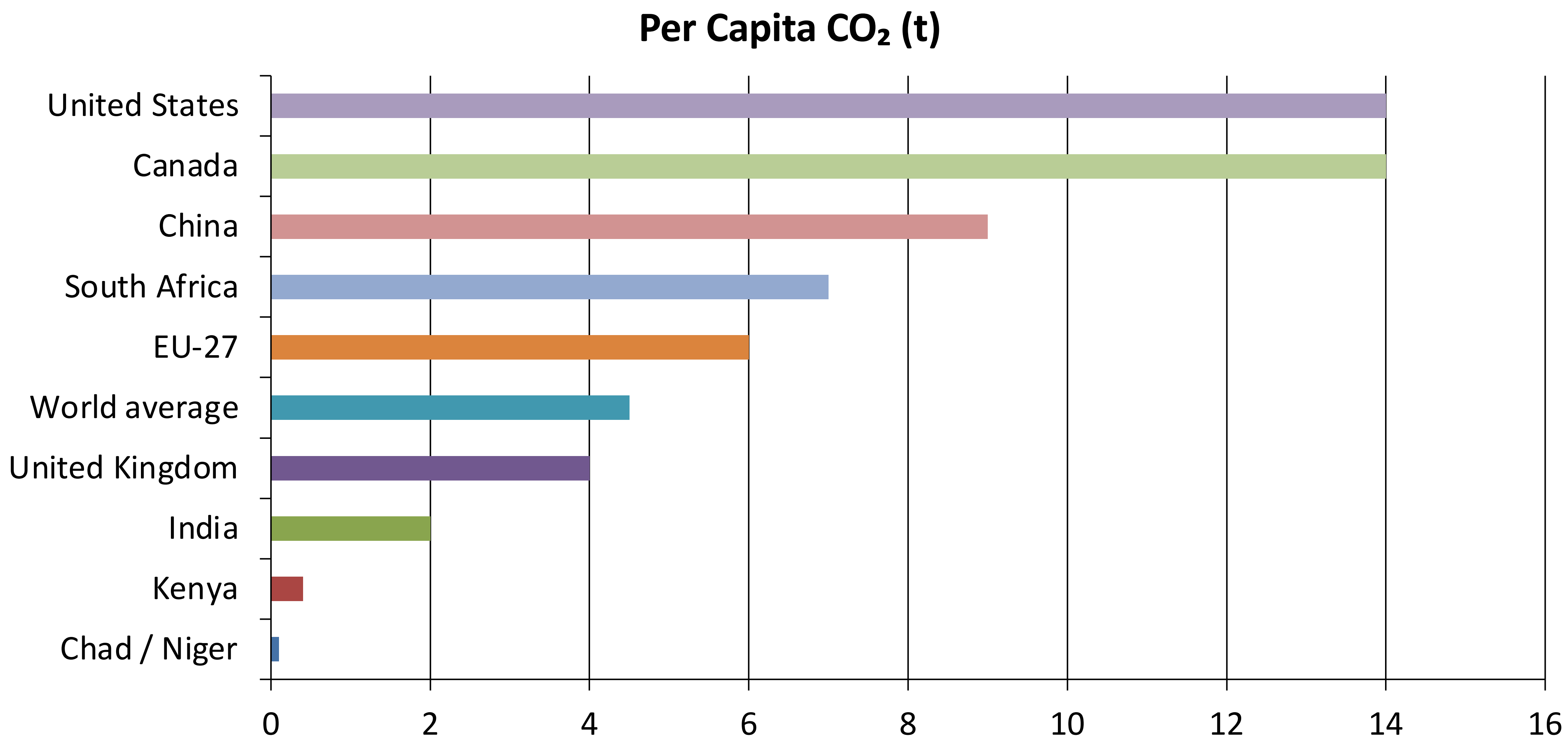
China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO_2



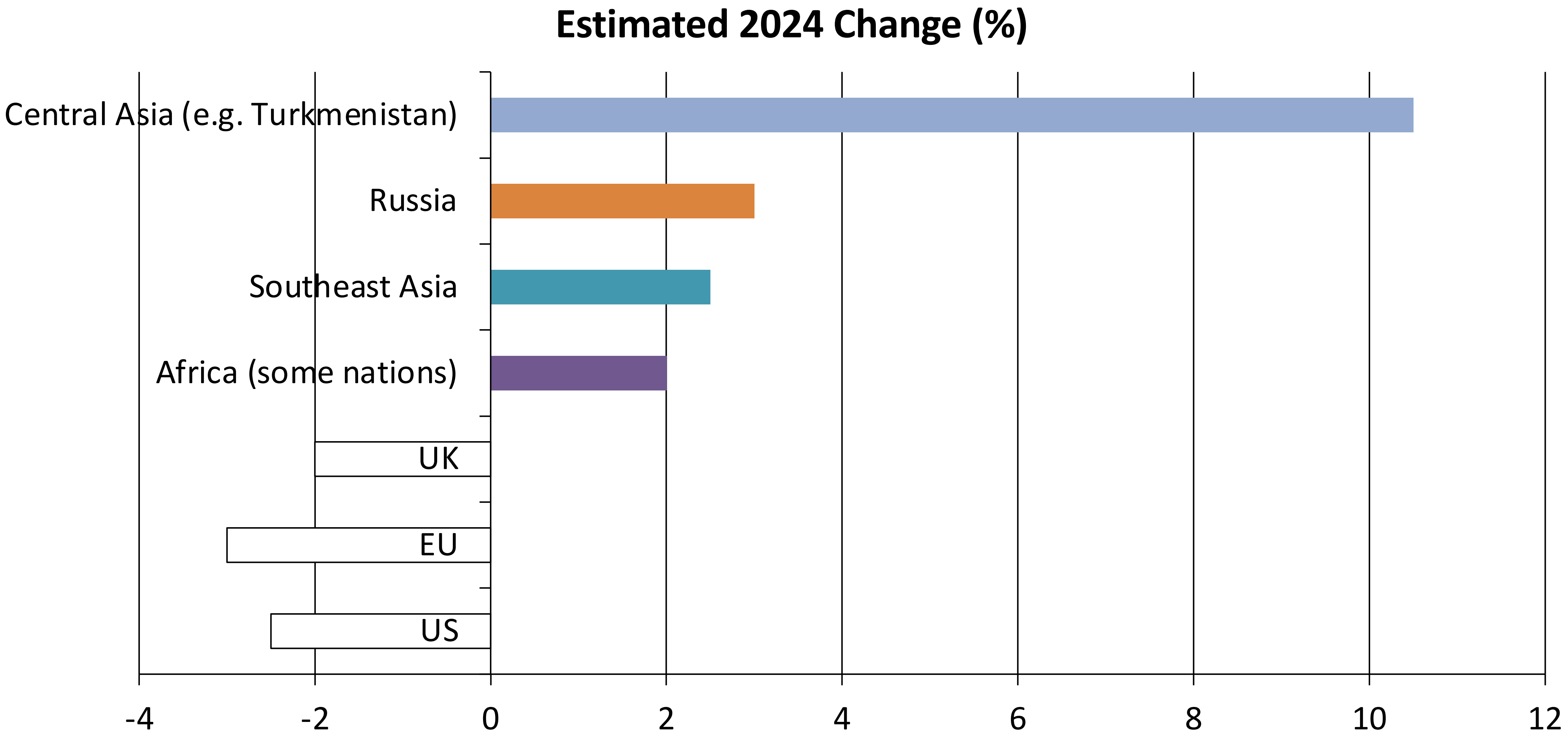
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



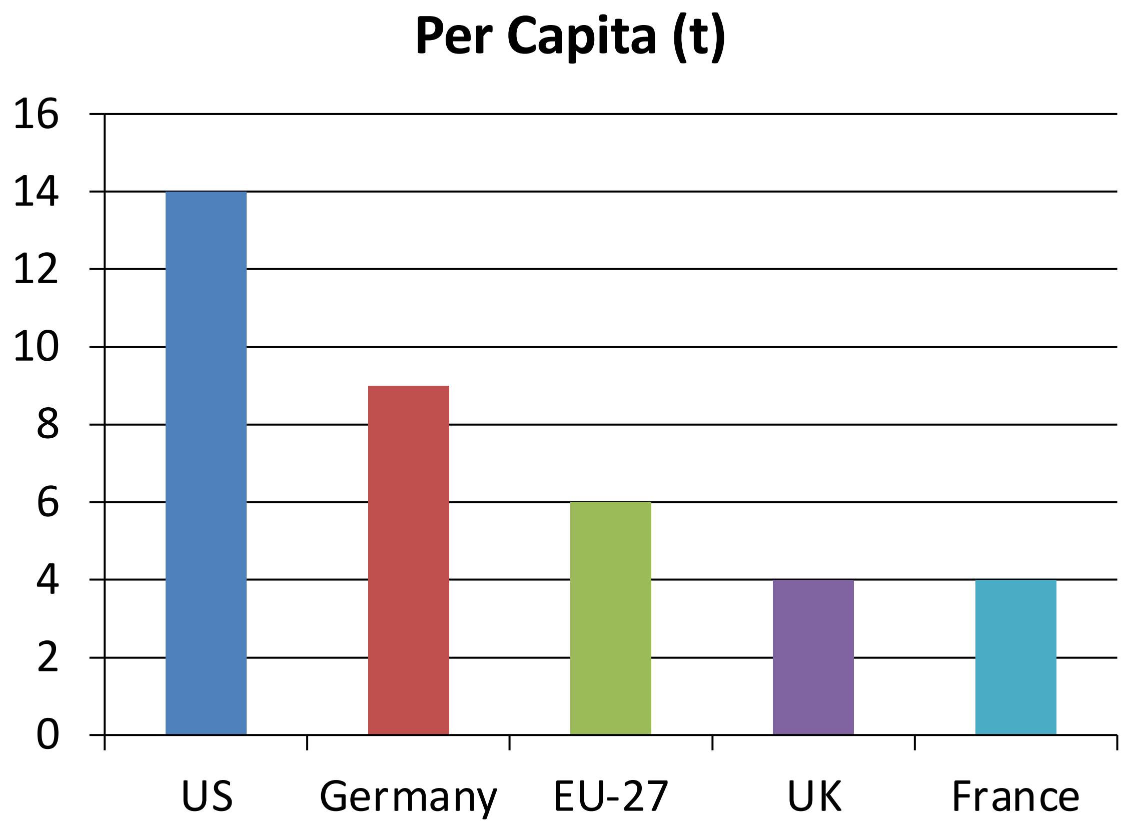
2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



*Note: Illustrative percentages based on 2024 qualitative trends showing declines in Western nations and increases elsewhere.

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

- Energy policy drives significant differences among wealthy nations:
- France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions.
- Germany, the Netherlands, and the US have higher per capita emissions.
- The primary driver is the share of electricity from nuclear and renewable sources versus fossil fuels.



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and haven't peaked.
- China is the largest annual emitter but per capita still below the US.
- Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US.
- Per capita gaps of 150x persist between richest and poorest nations.
- Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.